Exam Proctor: Faculty Handbook

How to run a class test with Exam Proctor · Version 1 · October 2026

Exam Proctor lets you decide which websites students may use during an online test, and shows you live, on one screen, any student who goes elsewhere. It uses no camera, microphone or screen recording. This handbook takes you from your first sign-in to reviewing the results.

Dashboard (for you)	`https://exam-proctor-rhbo.onrender.com/dashboard`, in any browser
Extension (for students)	`https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/jheoooojginplgillkdegkhlgblcmoimd`, free, Google Chrome only
Your login	An **invigilator** account from Nikhil D Jonathan (`nikhildj@xime.org`). You see only the tests you create, up to your exam limit
Class size	Used with 60 students in one test. For larger classes, tell Nikhil in advance (section 2)
Hand to students	**Exam Proctor Student Guide** (separate PDF)
Support	`nikhildj@xime.org`

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1. What it does, and what it doesn't

It does

- Check each student's active tab against **your** list of allowed sites
- Warn the student on screen the moment they leave it
- Show you every student live, with problems first, and raise a **flag** within seconds
- Notice switching to another app, other open tabs, a closed browser, a removed extension
- Keep a timeline of every page visited, for review after the test

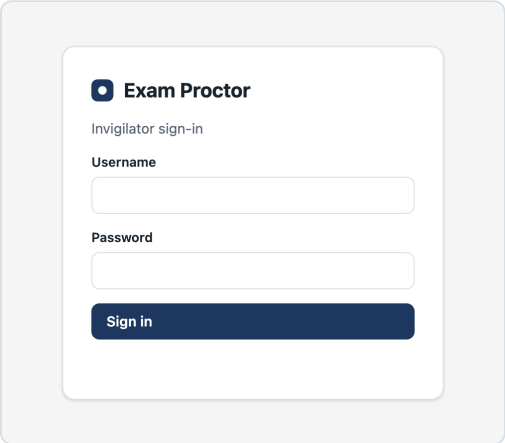
It doesn't

- See phones, second computers, books or people in the room
- See other browsers (only that the student left Chrome)
- Record keystrokes, page content, the screen, camera or microphone
- Block anything: it warns and records
- Decide misconduct: every flag is a prompt for **your** judgement

Students install a free Chrome extension once, then join each test with a **test code** (which you give them in advance), their **roll number**, and a **PIN** that you announce at the start. Monitoring runs only between the test's start and end times.

2. Before your first test

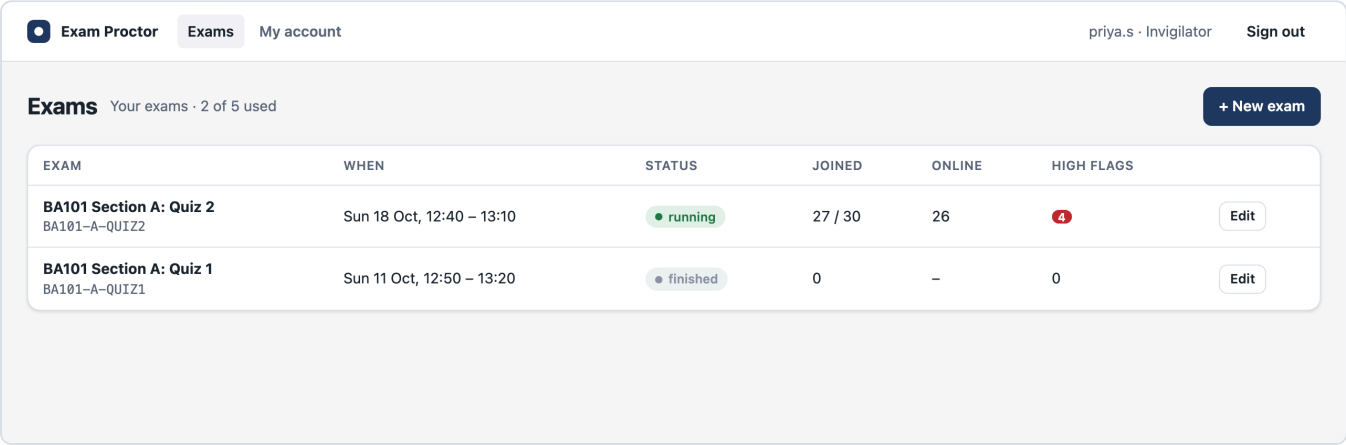
1. **Get an account.** Email `nikhildj@xime.org` with your name, preferred username and how many tests you plan to run this term. You will receive an invigilator account with a temporary password and an exam limit.
2. **Sign in** at the dashboard address above. The first visit of the day can take up to a minute while the server wakes up.
3. **Change your password** straight away: **My account** → **Change my password** (at least 10 characters).
4. **Tell Nikhil about your test** (date, time and class size) when you schedule it, so he can help on the day and plan around other large tests.



The sign-in page

Your account

- You see and manage **only the tests you create**. Colleagues cannot see yours, and you cannot see theirs. Admins can see every test.
- Your **exam limit** is the most tests you can have at once (shown on the Exams page, for example "2 of 5 used"). Delete old tests, after exporting their flags, or ask Nikhil to raise it.
- Test codes are shared across the institute: name tests `COURSE-SECTION-TEST`, for example `BA101-A-QUIZ2`. If a code is taken, choose another.
- A colleague helping you invigilate cannot open your test from their own account. They watch on your signed-in screen, or ask an admin.



The Exams list: your own tests with their status, how many students joined and open high flags, and how much of your exam limit you have used

3. Planning a test

Is Exam Proctor right for this test?

It works best for timed online tests where students should use only a few specific resources: an online quiz (Google Forms, Microsoft Forms, the LMS), a notebook platform, a calculator or documentation. For a test taken entirely on paper, or one that needs many websites, it adds little.

Choosing the allowed sites

List every site a student genuinely needs, **including the sign-in page** your quiz platform sends them through. Anything not listed is flagged. Each line can be:

You write	What it allows
`kaggle.com`	The whole site and its subdomains (`www.kaggle.com`), every page
`docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQ…`	Only that one Google Form. Google Docs, Sheets and other forms stay flagged
`desmos.com/calculator`	Only the Desmos calculator, not the rest of Desmos

> **Google Forms: remove `/viewform` from the end**
>
> When you paste a form link, delete `/viewform` (and anything after it). After a student presses **Submit**, Google moves them to `…/formResponse` ; with `/viewform` on your line, that page would be flagged for the whole class. Appendix A lists tested entries for common platforms.

The other settings

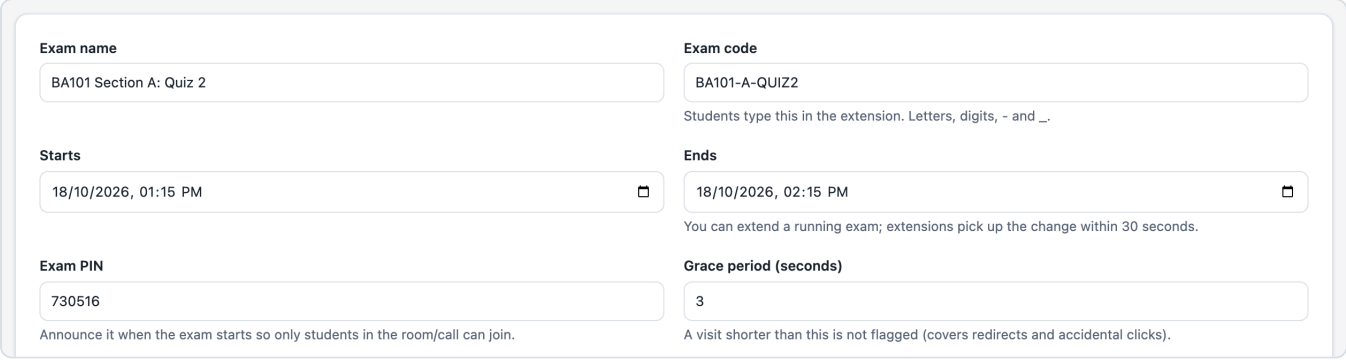
Setting	What to choose
Test code	`COURSE-SECTION-TEST` , letters, digits and dashes. Students type it, so keep it short
Start and end	The real test window. Students can join any time before the end; monitoring starts at the start time. You can extend the end time during the test
PIN	4 to 12 letters or digits; a new one for every test. Announce it only at the start
Grace period	3 seconds (default). Shorter visits, such as redirects and mis-clicks, are not flagged
Flag leaving Chrome	**On** for most tests. Switch it **off** if students must use a desktop app (for example Excel), or every one of them will be flagged
Block sites that aren't allowed	Off by default. Turn it on to stop other websites opening at all during the test: students see a "blocked" page instead, and each attempt is flagged. See the box below first
Class roster	Recommended: paste roll numbers and names from a spreadsheet. Only listed students can join, and you see who hasn't joined

Before you turn on blocking

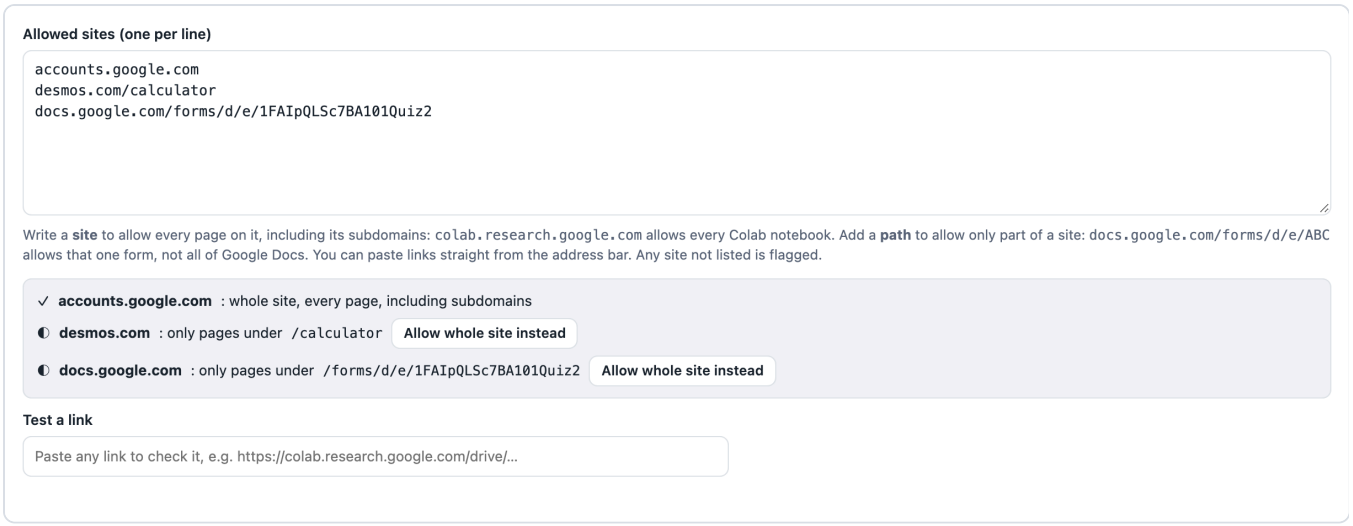
- **Your allowed list must be complete.** Without blocking, a missing site causes a flag; with blocking, students cannot get through at all. Test every link, including the sign-in page, in **Test a link**.
- **Students need extension 3.1 or later.** Chrome updates it automatically, but after this update it may **pause** the extension until each student accepts a new permission ("Block content on any page"). Ask students to check, before the test, that Exam Proctor is switched on.
- **Run a practice test with blocking on** first. If a needed site is blocked during the real test, click **Allow <site>** on one of its flags: it opens for everyone within about 30 seconds.
- Blocking works inside Chrome only. Other apps, other browsers and phones are still only flagged.

4. Creating the test in the dashboard

1. Click **+ New exam** and fill in the name, code, start, end, PIN and grace period.
2. Type or paste the **Allowed sites**, one per line. Read the preview under the box: each line says whether it allows a whole site or only part of one.
3. Paste every link your test uses into **Test a link**. Each must say **Allowed**. Also try one that should be flagged.
4. Paste the **Class roster**: one student per line, roll number then name. You can copy two columns straight from Excel.
5. Click **Create exam**. The test appears in the list as **scheduled**.



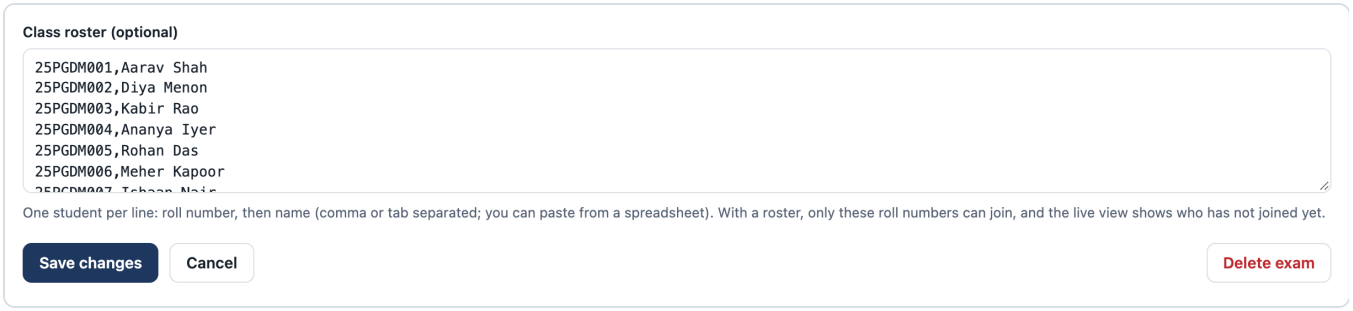
The top of the exam form



Allowed sites for a Google Forms quiz with Desmos. ◐ means only part of the site is allowed, which is what you want here. Don't press "Allow whole site instead" for the form, because that would allow all of Google Docs



Test a link: a Google Doc would be flagged, because only the quiz form is allowed. Leave the "Allow docs.google.com" button alone in this case



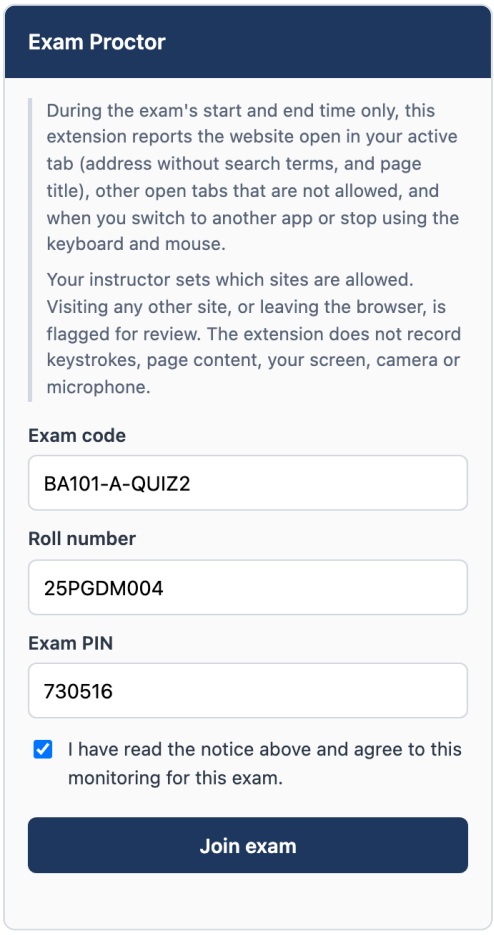
The class roster, pasted from a spreadsheet

> **Run a practice test first**
>
> Create a 10-minute test called, say, `BA101-A-PRACTICE` a few days before the real one, with the same allowed sites. Students install the extension and join it once. Installation problems then surface before they matter, and you can check your allowed-sites list with real students.

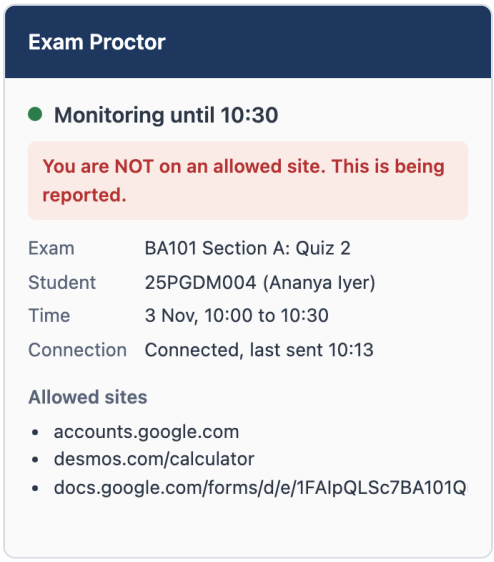
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5. Preparing your students

1. **One week before:** email the class the **Student Guide** PDF, the test code and the date (template in Appendix C). Say clearly what is and isn't recorded.
2. **Offer an alternative** to any student who doesn't consent, can't use Chrome, or has accessibility needs. Ask them to tell you before the test.
3. **Two or three days before:** run the practice test, or at least ask everyone to install and pin the extension.
4. **The day before:** send a reminder (Appendix C): Chrome, the extension, signed in to any accounts the test needs (for example Google), laptop charged.



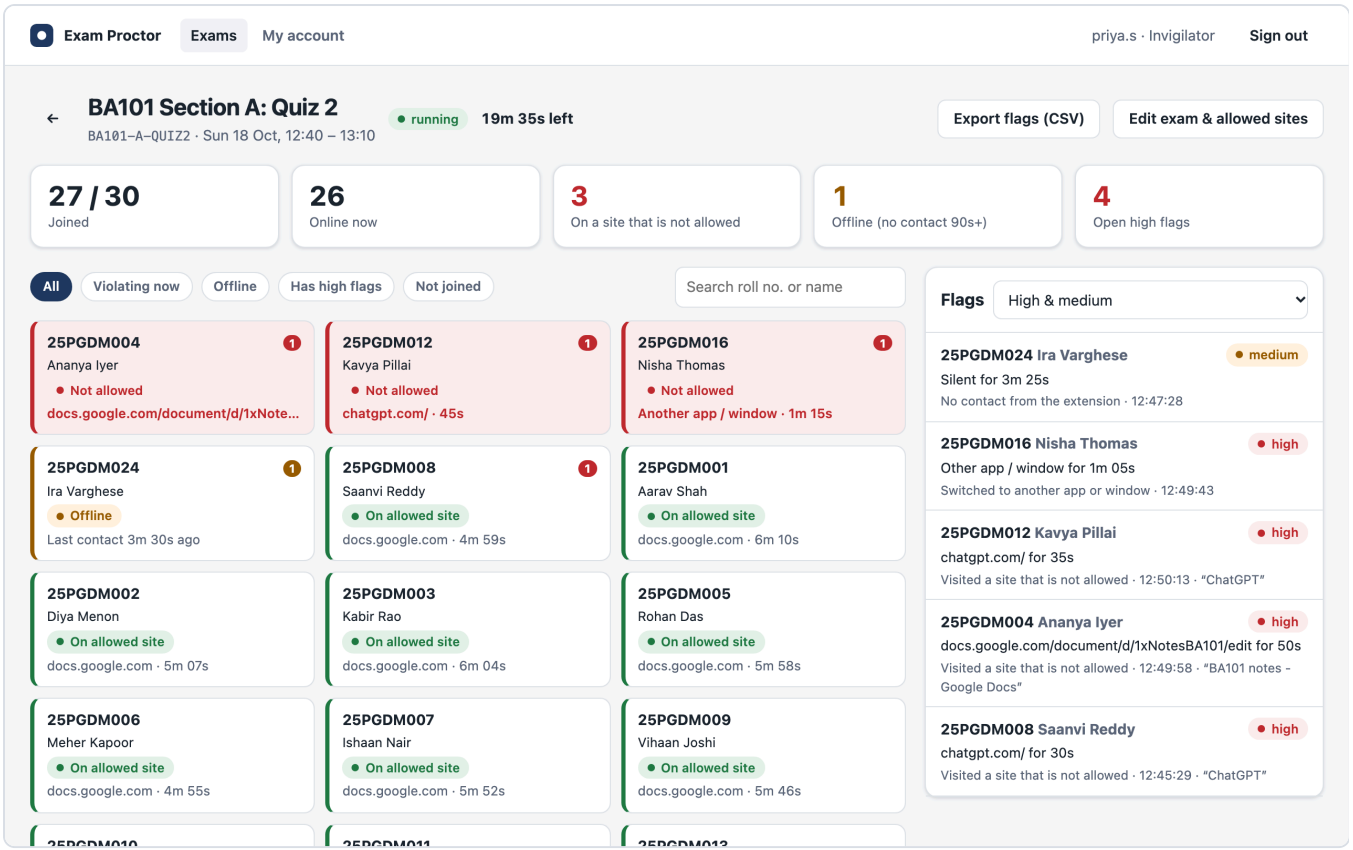
What students fill in to join



What a student sees on a site that is not allowed. A pop-up notification also appears

6. On test day

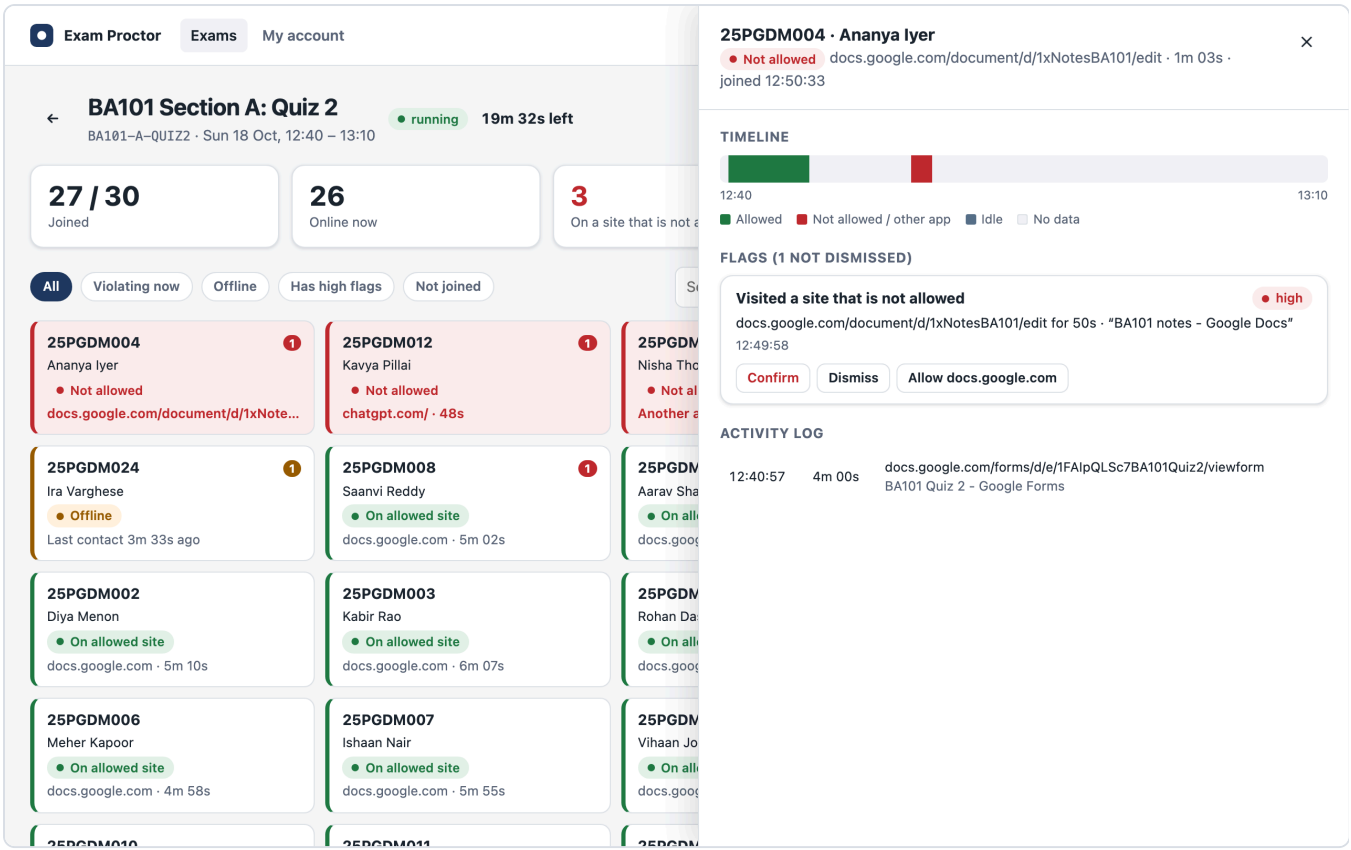
When	What to do
15 minutes before	Sign in to the dashboard (this also wakes the server) and open your test's live view by clicking it in the list
5 minutes before	Announce the PIN. Watch **Joined X / Y**; use the **Not joined** filter to help anyone who is missing
Start	Release the quiz itself. Monitoring starts automatically at the start time
During	Watch for red tiles. You don't need to act on every flag during the test; you will review them afterwards
End	Monitoring stops automatically. Wait 15 minutes before reviewing: late uploads from students who lost Wi-Fi still arrive



The live view: 27 of 30 joined, 3 on a site that is not allowed right now, 1 offline. Problems are sorted first

On screen	Meaning
Five numbers	Joined out of the roster · online now · on a site that is not allowed **right now** · offline 90 s or more · open high flags
Green tile	On an allowed site
Red tile	On a site that is not allowed, or in another app, and for how long
Amber tile	Offline: no contact for 90 seconds (Wi-Fi lost, Chrome closed, extension switched off)
Grey tile	Not joined yet
Red and amber numbers	The student's high and medium flags so far
Flags panel	Each new flag as it happens. A pop-up message also appears for each new high flag

The screen updates itself every 3 seconds. Click any tile or flag to open that student's panel:



A student's panel: timeline (green allowed, red not), flags with Confirm, Dismiss and Allow, and every page visited

Situations and what to do

You see	What to do
Many students flagged on the same site at once	The test probably needs that site, for example a sign-in page. Check the address; if it's genuinely needed, click **Allow <site>** on one of the flags. That adds it for everyone, turns tiles green and dismisses its flags. Students' extensions update within 30 seconds.
"Allow docs.google.com" offered for a Google Doc	Don't click it in a Forms quiz: it would allow all of Google Docs and Sheets. Treat the visit as a normal flag.
An amber tile	Usually Wi-Fi. If it was only Wi-Fi, the flag drops to `low` on its own when the student reconnects.
A student can't join	Check the code, the PIN and that their roll number is on the roster. Edit the roster if needed; they can join any time before the end.
Students need more time	**Edit exam & allowed sites** → change **Ends** → **Save**. Extensions pick it up within 30 seconds.
"Cannot reach the exam server" for many students	Check the room's Wi-Fi first. If the dashboard is also down, note the time; extensions keep recording and send everything when it returns.

7. After the test: reviewing flags

1. Wait 15 minutes after the end, then open the test's live view.

2. For each student with flags, open their panel and read the flag together with the **timeline** and **activity log**. Context matters more than a single flag.
3. **Dismiss** flags with an innocent explanation and **Confirm** those that need follow-up. Add a short note either way; it records your name.
4. Click **Export flags (CSV)** and keep the file with your test records.
5. Follow the institute's academic integrity process for anything confirmed. A flag is never enough on its own: show the student the record and hear their explanation.

Flag	Common innocent causes	What to check
high Site not allowed	A missing sign-in page; a redirect; a mis-click that lasted over 3 seconds	The site, the page title and how long. Seconds on a sign-in page differ from minutes on an AI tool
high Left the browser	A system pop-up, a notification, a password manager	How long, and how often. Ten seconds once is different from repeated long absences
high Removed the extension	Rare by accident	Ask the student. Check for gaps around the same time
medium No contact	Wi-Fi drop, laptop battery, Chrome crash	How long. A real network drop is usually downgraded to low automatically
medium Different or shared browser	Reinstalled extension, changed laptop	Two students on one browser is worth a conversation
medium Blocked attempt	A link inside the quiz, a mis-click, a search typed out of habit	What they tried to open, and how often. Many students blocked on one site usually means it should be allowed
low Tab open	A tab left open from before the test	Whether they ever switched to it (activity log)

Records are deleted 90 days after each test, unless a case is under review. Ask Nikhil to keep a test's records longer if a case is open.

8. Limits and responsible use

- **Design questions that reward understanding.** Monitoring deters casual misuse; it cannot see a phone or a friend in the room.
- **Tell students exactly what is recorded**, and never present the tool as more powerful than it is.
- **Keep the allowed list tight but complete.** Each extra site is extra freedom; each missing one is a false alarm for the whole class.
- **Platforms that host other people's work** (Kaggle, GitHub) are allowed as a whole site. Students could browse others' public notebooks there without a flag; check the activity logs.
- **Students can switch the extension off on their own laptops.** That is flagged, not prevented. On institution-managed laptops, IT can force-install it.
- **Handle the data with care:** it identifies students. Share CSVs only with people who need them.

9. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
The dashboard is slow to open	The server sleeps when unused and wakes in about a minute. Always open it 15 minutes before a test.
"Wrong username or password"	Usernames are case-sensitive. After 8 wrong tries, sign-in from that network locks for 10 minutes; ask Nikhil to reset your password.
"You have reached your limit of N exams"	Export the flags of an old test and delete it, or ask Nikhil to raise your limit.
"An exam with this code already exists"	Codes are unique across the institute. Add your section or the term, for example `BA101-A-QUIZ2-OCT`.
Student: "No exam with this code"	Check the spelling; codes are not case-sensitive but must match exactly otherwise.
Student: "Not on the list for this exam"	Their roll number is missing or mistyped in your roster. Edit the exam and fix it.
Student: "Incorrect exam PIN"	PINs are case-sensitive. Repeat it slowly, or write it on the board.
Student: "Cannot reach the exam server"	Their internet, or the server waking up. Wait a minute and retry.
Everyone flagged on the same page	A needed site is missing: use **Allow <site>** (section 6) and remember it for next time.
A student's laptop blocks extensions	Managed by another organisation's IT. Offer the alternative arrangement.

Appendix A: allowed sites for common platforms

Platform	Add these lines	Notes
Google Forms quiz	`docs.google.com/forms/d/e/<FORM-ID>` `accounts.google.com`	Copy the form link and delete `/viewform`. Other forms, Docs and Sheets stay flagged
Microsoft Forms	`forms.office.com` `forms.cloud.microsoft` `login.microsoftonline.com`	Microsoft uses both addresses for Forms. Links can't be narrowed to one form, so all Microsoft Forms are allowed
Learning platform (Moodle or similar)	Your LMS address, for example `lms.yourinstitute.edu`	Students can also see course materials there; fine for open-book tests
Kaggle notebook	`kaggle.com` `accounts.google.com`	Other people's public notebooks are on the same site (section 8)

Platform	Add these lines	Notes
Google Colab	`colab.research.google.com` `accounts.google.com`	Covers every notebook. `colab.google` is a different site (Google's developer pages)
Desmos calculator	`desmos.com/calculator`	Only the calculator
Python documentation	`pandas.pydata.org`, `seaborn.pydata.org`, `matplotlib.org`, `docs.python.org`	Add only what the test allows

Avoid broad entries such as `google.com` (which includes Search and Gemini), `microsoft.com` (Bing and Copilot) or `office.com` (Copilot, Word, OneDrive). The dashboard warns you if you type one.

Appendix B: what each flag means

Flag (as shown)	Level	Raised when
Visited a site that is not allowed	high	The active tab stays on a site that is not on the list for longer than the grace period
Switched to another app or window	high	Another app is in front for longer than the grace period (only if "Flag leaving Chrome" is on)
Removed the extension during the exam	high	Chrome reports that the extension was uninstalled
Opened a browser page	medium	Chrome settings, extensions page or a local file
Screen locked or computer asleep	medium	The screen locks during the test
No contact from the extension	medium / low	Silent for 90 seconds; low when it was only a network drop
Rejoined from a different browser	medium	The same roll number joins from another browser or after a reinstall
Same browser used for another roll number	medium	Two roll numbers join from one browser
Tried to open a site that is not allowed (blocked)	medium	Blocking is on and the extension stopped a page from opening
Has a tab open on a site that is not allowed	low	A background tab is on a site that is not on the list

Appendix C: messages to send students

ONE WEEK BEFORE (ATTACH THE STUDENT GUIDE)

Subject: [COURSE] [TEST NAME] on [DATE]: online monitoring with Exam Proctor

Dear students, [TEST NAME] on [DATE] from [START] to [END] will be monitored with Exam Proctor, a Chrome extension that checks you stay on the allowed sites: [LIST THE SITES]. It records only the address and title of the pages you visit, and when you leave Chrome, between the start and end time. It does not record keystrokes, your screen, camera or microphone.

Before [DATE]: install it from https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/jheooojginplgillkdegkhlgblcmoimd and follow the attached Student Guide. The test code is **[CODE]**; the PIN will be announced at the start. If you cannot use Chrome or do not wish to be monitored, tell me by [DATE] so we can arrange an alternative.

THE DAY BEFORE

Reminder: [TEST NAME] tomorrow at [START]. Please bring a charged laptop with Google Chrome and the Exam Proctor extension pinned, and be signed in to [ACCOUNTS, e.g. your Google account] beforehand. Close tabs you don't need. Code: **[CODE]**.